07-27 第一篇

Urban Noise Pollution: The Unseen Problem

When we think of city pollution, we often picture smog, litter, or dirty water. But there is another type of pollution that affects millions of city dwellers every day: noise. Traffic, construction, sirens, and loud music fill the urban soundscape. Unlike other pollutants, noise is invisible, but its effects are real. [1] Noise pollution is increasingly recognized as a threat to health and well-being. Understanding its sources, effects, and solutions can help us create quieter, healthier cities.

Where does urban noise come from? [2] Traffic is the biggest source—cars, buses, trucks, and motorcycles produce constant noise on busy streets. Construction sites add drills, jackhammers, and heavy machinery. Airplanes flying over cities create loud roars. Restaurants, shops, and nightlife contribute to the sound mix. Even at home, neighbors, air conditioners, and street noise can penetrate walls. The combination of these sources makes cities noisier than ever. Quiet moments have become a luxury.

The health impacts are serious. [3] Chronic exposure to loud noise can raise blood pressure, disturb sleep, and increase stress. Students in noisy schools often have trouble concentrating and may perform worse on tests. Hospital patients recover more slowly in noisy environments. Long-term exposure can even lead to hearing loss. The World Health Organization lists noise as one of the top environmental health risks in Europe. Noise does not just annoy us—it harms our bodies and minds.

Cities are starting to take action. [4] Some cities have created quiet zones near schools and hospitals. Traffic can be reduced in certain areas, or vehicles can be required to meet stricter noise standards. Buildings can be designed with better sound insulation. Planting trees along streets can absorb and block sound. Public awareness campaigns encourage people to lower music volumes and avoid unnecessary honking. Technology such as noise barriers and quiet pavement is also being used. Small changes can add up to a noticeably quieter environment.

Noise pollution may be invisible, but we can no longer ignore it. [5] By implementing smart policies and encouraging considerate behavior, we can reduce urban noise and protect public health. Everyone deserves the right to peace and quiet. Whether you live in a tall apartment or a house by the road, your voice matters. Speak up for quieter neighborhoods, support noise-reduction measures, and do your part to turn down the volume. A quieter city is a healthier city—for all of us.

选项

A. It is now seen as a serious threat to health and quality of life. B. It comes from many sources, with traffic being the largest contributor. C. It can cause physical and mental health problems over time. D. Various measures can be taken to reduce noise in urban areas. E. We need policies and personal action to create quieter, healthier cities. F. For example, some people wear earplugs to sleep in noisy neighborhoods.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍噪音无形但有影响，空后总领"sources, effects, solutions"，A项"它正日益被视为对健康与生活质量的严重威胁"承上启下，将现象与关注度衔接，与后文探讨框架呼应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：本段回答"Where does urban noise come from?"，空后列举交通、建筑、飞机、商业、家庭等来源，并强调交通为最大来源，B项"来自多种来源，其中交通是最大贡献者"准确概括。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：本段主题为"The health impacts are serious"，空后具体描述血压、睡眠、压力、学生专注、病人康复、听力损害、WHO 警告等，C项"长期可导致身心健康问题"概括健康影响。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：本段讲城市应对措施，空后列举安静区、限行、车辆标准、建筑隔音、绿化、公众宣传、技术手段等，D项"可采取多种措施减少城市噪音"概括解决方案。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：结尾段总结并号召，空前总述不能忽视，空后"implementing policies""considerate behavior""reduce noise""protect health""do your part"，E项"需要政策与个人行动共创更安静、更健康的城市"呼应行动号召。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some people wear earplugs to sleep in noisy neighborhoods.**：以 For example 开头，涉及噪音应对，但仅为个人应对举例，与 [4] 空后城市层面的政策措施层次不同，无法作为段首概括，为干扰项。